7 INT. NIGHT TRAIN - DINING CAR - NIGHT (MOVING) 7

Lamps sway. Cutlery RATTLES with every join in the rails. Most of the tables are empty.

INGRID Solberg, 40s, sits alone with a whisky and a crossword. She hasn't filled in a single answer.

START> SGT. D'ARCY, 30s, plain clothes, sits down opposite her without asking.

SGT. D'ARCY
Seven letters. 'Left in a hurry.'

INGRID
Departed.

SGT. D'ARCY
That's eight.

INGRID
(not looking up)
Then it's 'escaped'. Which I imagine is why you're sitting there.

SGT. D'ARCY
You know who I am.

INGRID
You've walked past my compartment four times since Crewe. Either you're police or you're very lost.

GUARD (V.O.) (over tannoy)
The next station stop is Carlisle. Carlisle, next stop.

D'Arcy waits for the announcement to finish.

SGT. D'ARCY
Your husband got off at Preston.

INGRID
My husband gets off wherever he likes.

SGT. D'ARCY
(leaning in, lowering his voice so the steward can't hear)
He got off at Preston with a bag that doesn't belong to him, and he left you on this train to make it look like he was still on it. We've had him on camera since Euston. Platform four, blue holdall, your car keys in his hand. And you in the window seat,
(MORE)

SGT. D'ARCY (CONT'D)
doing this crossword. Same crossword. Same empty squares.

Ingrid finally puts her pen down.

INGRID
Is that a question, Sergeant?

SGT. D'ARCY
No.

INGRID
Then I don't have to answer it.

The train LURCHES. Her whisky slides across the table. D'Arcy catches it.

SGT. D'ARCY
Where's he going, Mrs. Solberg?

INGRID
STOP CALLING ME THAT!

The few other DINERS turn to look. Ingrid lowers her voice.

INGRID (CONT'D)
Solberg was his name. I'm keeping the whisky. He can have the name back.

END> D'Arcy slides the glass back to her. She drinks.

7A INT. NIGHT TRAIN - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS 7A

D'Arcy steps out and flattens himself against the window as a STEWARD squeezes past with a trolley.

SGT. D'ARCY (into radio)
She knows. Have Carlisle hold the platform.

STEWARD
Tea, coffee? Anything from the trolley?

SGT. D'ARCY Coffee. Black. It's going to be a long night.

The train plunges into a tunnel. The corridor goes BLACK.

8 EXT. WEST COAST MAIN LINE - NIGHT 8

The sleeper thunders north out of the tunnel, every window lit, into the dark.